

INFOSYS 704

IT Consultancy

Lecture 2

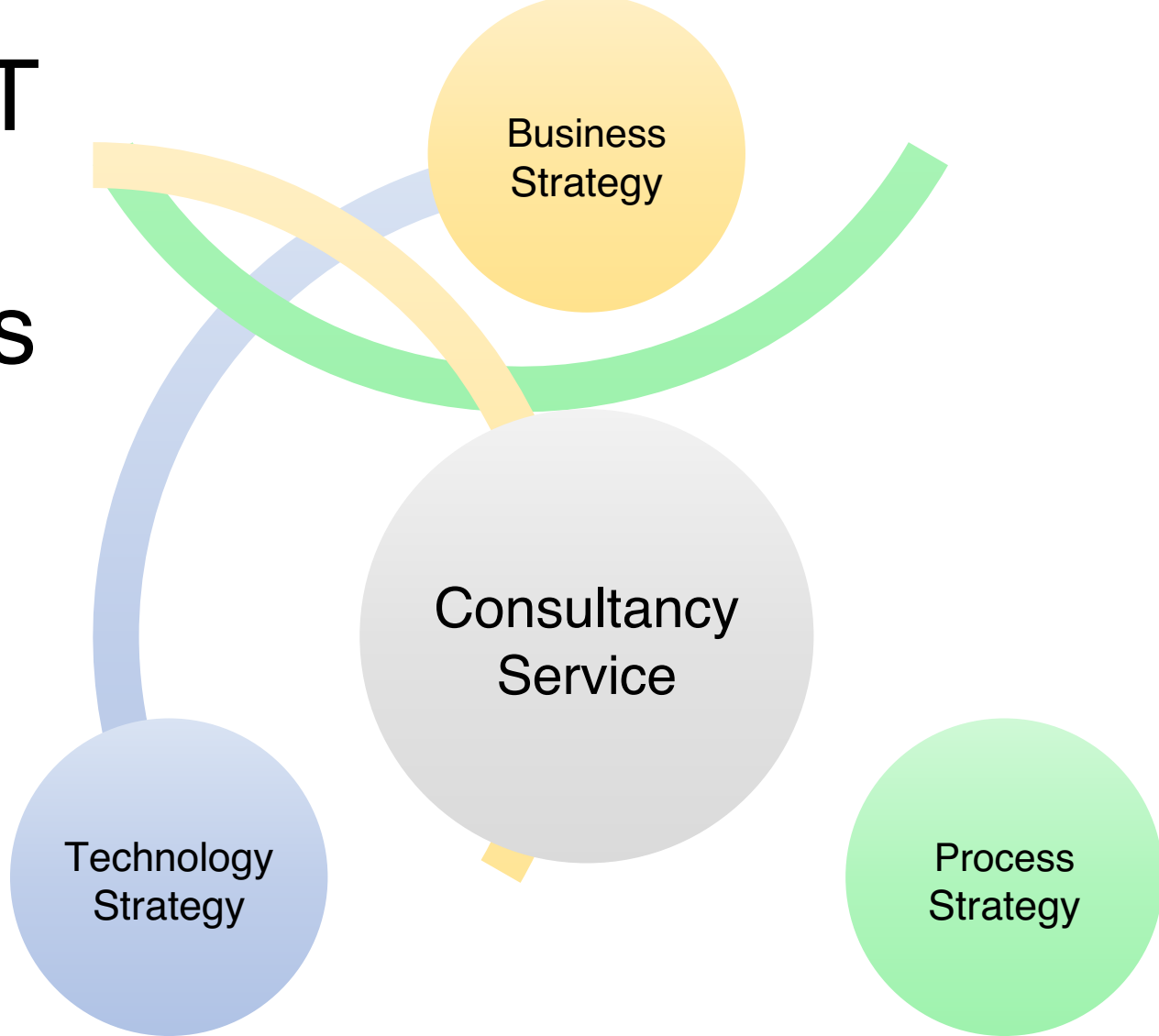
IT Consulting





Definitions

Gartner defines IT Consulting as “advisory services that help clients **assess different technology strategies** and, in doing so, **align their technology strategy** with their **business** or **process** strategy.”



McKinsey “We help clients
unlock the power of AI at scale ,
modernize technology delivery ,
and **build new businesses** to
fuel growth....use technology
to **solve problems** in business..
transform their businesses ..
create value”

The IT Consultancy Process

Current Situation

Descriptive

Vendor Model



**Best
Business
Practices**

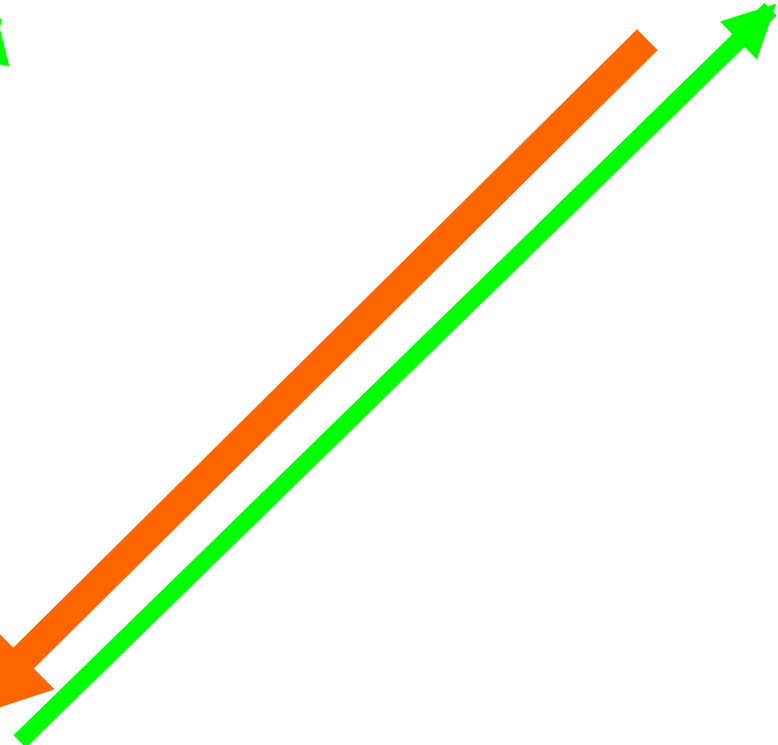
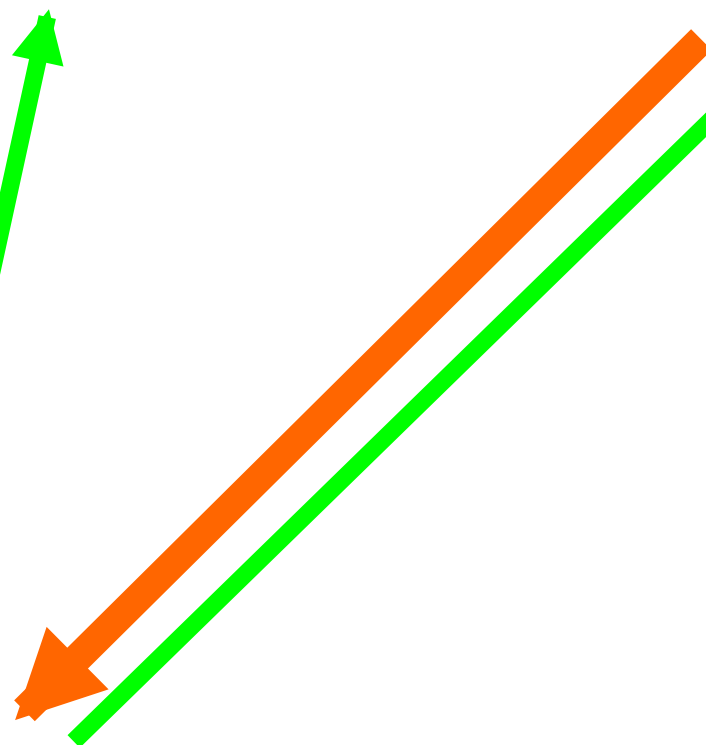
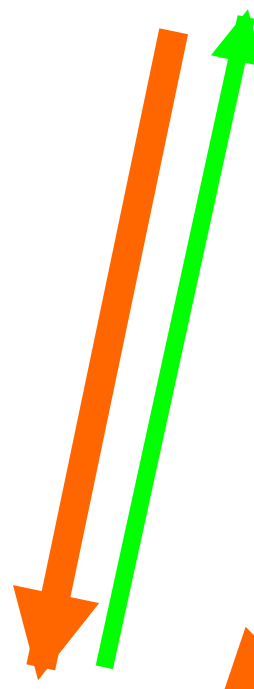
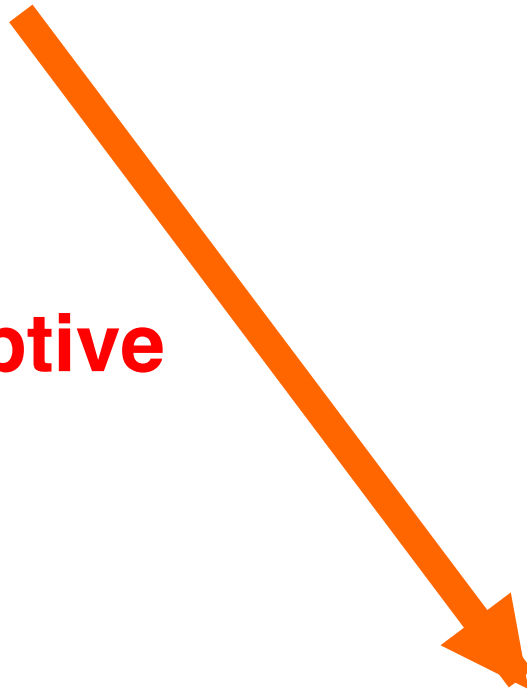
AS-IS



Reference



Prescriptive



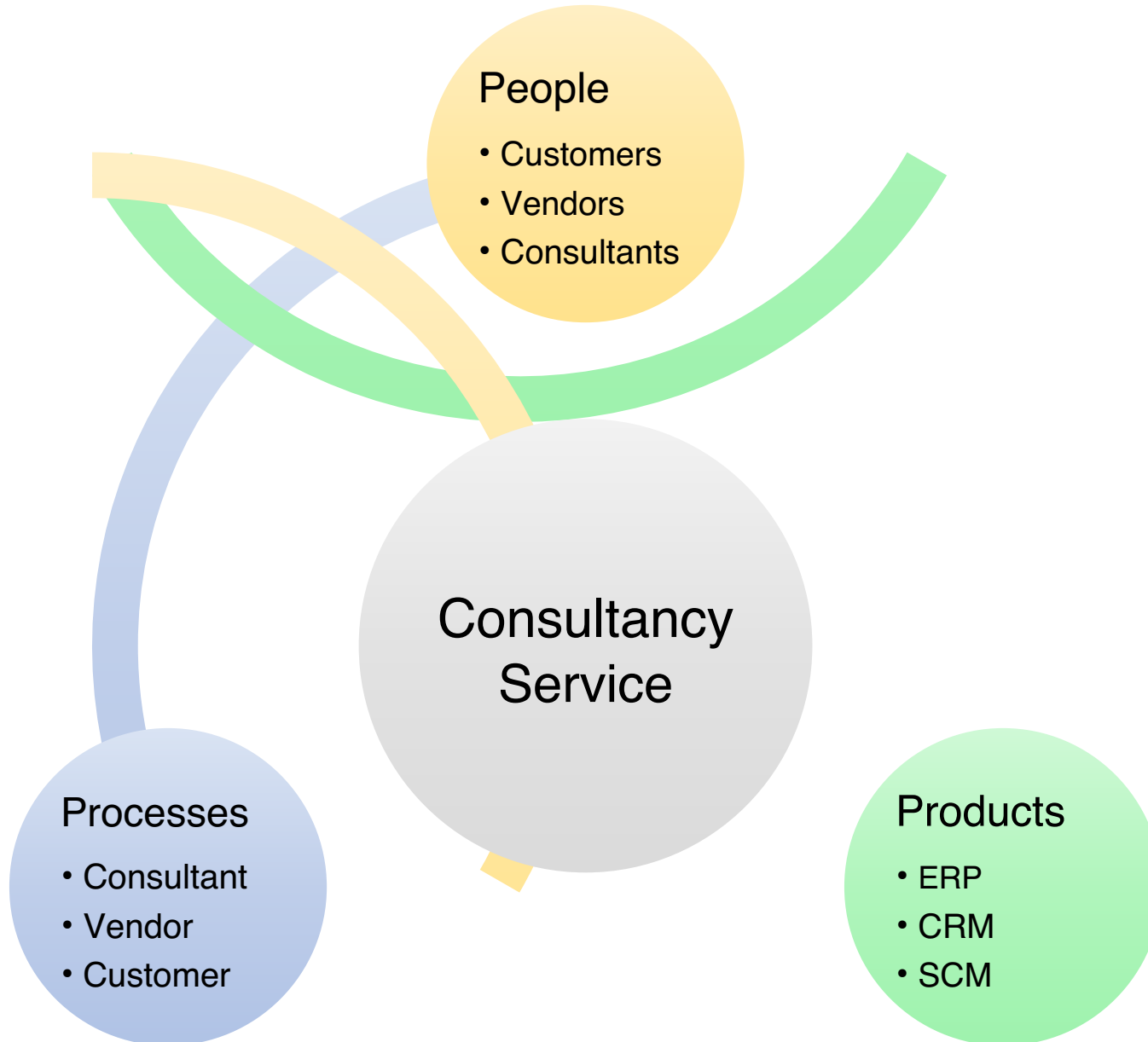
TO-BE

Target Situation

Normative

Accenture “use technology to expand into **new markets**, develop **new customer capabilities**, create **new products and services**, and improve overall **competitiveness, performance and innovation.**”

The IT Consultancy Ecosystem



KPMG “Working with you to
define your technology vision
and **make it a reality**.”

"Vision without action is a
daydream. Action without a
vision is a **nightmare**." Japanese
Proverb

PwC “adopting the right technologies to **accelerate transformation**, drive efficiency and power **new opportunities**.. tech-powered solutions so you can **move faster** and **smarter**”

EY “help solve the **world’s toughest challenges**? Using **AI** to detect **cancer** earlier in patients. Helping clients to prevent **cyber hacks** by implementing **blockchain** technology. Imagine working with **advanced analytics** to help farmers increase **food production.**”

Consulting Landscape

Based on Anil Sengupta's 2024 Lectures

Consulting Landscape

- **Corporate Strategy**

- McKinsey, Bain, BCG, Booz, Accenture
- Examples of corporate strategy consulting
 - Market entry
 - Growth strategy
 - Merger & Acquisition
 - Product strategy
 - High level technology strategy

Company level

Consulting Landscape

mid level

- **Functional Strategy**

- Deloitte, KPMG, PwC, EY
- Examples of functional strategy
 - Go-to-market and sales effectiveness
 - Operational process reengineering
 - Shared-services
 - Finance processes and transformation
 - IT strategy
 - Process improvements using technology

Consulting Landscape

- **Delivery and Implementation** *level*
 - System Integrators
 - Consulting companies
 - The Big Four - Deloitte, PwC, EY, and KPMG
 - Accenture, Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, Wipro
- **Commercial models**
 - T&M – Time and Materials
 - Fixed price + buffer
 - Range
 - Revenue/growth share

Why hire consultants?

Based on Anil Sengupta's 2024 Lectures

Why do companies hire consultants?

- **Advisory**

- Gain cross-industry knowledge and experience through consultant
- Gain good advice from consultant's past experience with similar organisation and subject matter.

- **To enable decision-making at the Executive and Board levels**

- Non-impacted party – objective advisory
- Support for executive's decisions
- Board's review of executive decision
- Advisory to board

- **Resource capacity**

- Current team do not have capacity to undertake project or program of work
- Consultants are meant to be able to quickly learn the business and processes and add value and get the work accomplished₁₇

Why do companies hire consultants?

- **New ideas**

- Gain access to new ideas of doing things – based on consultants experience
- Brainstorm with intelligent and experienced consultants to resolve challenges

- **Influence change**

- Bring in externals to influence changes within the organisation and teams
- Team sizing exercises so there is little influence of relationships when making decisions on reduction of workforce

- **Deliver**

- Manage and run project delivery, including managing internal employees as part of the project.
- Manage and deliver IT projects that suit business needs, based on delivery experience in other organisations and industries.

Consulting Organisation Roles Tasks Careers

Based on Anil Sengupta's 2024 Lectures

Partnership consulting organisations

- Partner
- Director
- Senior Manager
- Manager
- Senior Consultant
- Consultant/Associate

Privately owned consulting organisations

- Owner/Director
- Head of Consulting
- Senior Manager/Principal Consultant
- Manager
- Consultant
- Associate

IT Consulting Project Roles

- Product manager
- Project manager
- Functional consultants
- Test manager
- Testers
- Business analysts
- Developers
- Integration specialists
- Change manager
- Change analyst
- Technical analyst
- Solutions designer
- UI/UX designers
- Solutions architect
- Program manager
- Others...

Day in the life of a consultant

- **Stakeholder management with**

- Your manager
- Your client project sponsor
- Client team you are interacting with
- Your coach within the consulting organisation

[VIDEO – IT CONSULTING VS MGMT. CONSULTING](#)

- **Meetings with**

- Your manager
- Your project team lead
- Your client contacts
- Starting positions may only sit in meetings as observers

Q: Please write down for yourself – what kind of consulting work you would like to do.

- **Presentations to**

- Your internal project team members
- To clients (as you move up the chain)

Day in the life of a consultant

- **Solve**

Q: Please write down for yourself – what kind of consulting work you would like to do.

- Problems on-hand
- Assist your manager with resolving challenges
- Assist your team mates if they get stuck
- Think for your team and manager! (V.IMP)

- **Analysis and reports on**

- Processes and tasks that are assigned to you by your manager or project team
- Understand and use tools available, with guidance from manager or project team
- Be proactive to learn more

- **Participate in**

- Client socials / Internal team socials / Knowledge based sessions / Trainings / Be proactive

Consulting Stories...

Problem Statement

- Losing sales in a specific segment to competitor
- Customer satisfaction was moderate
- Customers were asking for self-service

Approach

- Assess and determine true challenges - customer experience, manual processes
- Option design: 1) Improve existing processes, 2) Create online experience
- Recommendation
- Deliver

Outcomes

- Implemented a new online experience for customers who wanted self-service.
- Growth in double digits
- Reduction in churn of customers
- Improved customer satisfaction
- Revenue targets met, with better forecasting and planning

Consulting stories continued ...

Problem Statement

- Current ERP provider is getting costly while also lagging in quality of features and scalability
- System performance is lacking
- Customer experience is significantly lacking
- Financially, vendor seems unstable

Approach

- Assess current situation
- Option design 1) Replace, 2) Build skin on top of ERP, 3) Integrate to new financial system, then replace transactional system
- Recommendation: #2
- Deliver

Outcomes

- Delivered a new cart-like experience (UI/UX) skin on top of the ERP, using API integrations with ERP.
- Significantly improved transaction processing
- Competitors began to emulate this setup and ERP vendor asked to buy the product

Why opt for consulting?

- Training ground for fast paced knowledge transfer to you
- Gain experience across multiple types of projects and learn to deal with different types of people and stakeholders
- Soft skills training – not easy to gain in a non-consulting environment
- Work with smart people
- Learn more in shorter timeframes
- Ability to move through project teams and take up different roles
- Content knowledge especially with delivery roles can increase significantly

Q: Please write down – 3 reasons you want to be an IT consultant.

Career Path of an **IT Consultant**

Valeria Sadovykh

- UoA 40 under 40: [Dr Valeria Sadovykh - The University of Auckland](#)
- LinkedIn: [\(99+\) Valeria Sadovykh, Ph.D. | LinkedIn](#)
- Google Scholar: [Valeria Sadovykh - Google Scholar](#)

Reading Material - Case Studies

- **AI related – McKinsey & Co.**

- <https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/mckinsey-digital/how-we-help-clients/an-ai-power-play-fueling-the-next-wave-of-innovation-in-the-energy-sector>

- **Digital Transformation - KPMG**

- <https://kpmg-digital-design.com/roadmap-for-digital-transformation-in-the-energy-sector>

- **Customer Stories - SAP**

- <https://www.sap.com/australia/about/customer-stories.html>

